AGRICULTURE DATA PROCESSING

Satellite & Drone Crop Analytics

Service Scope, Rate Card and Pricing Guide

Multispectral index processing • Management zoning • GIS deliverables • Agronomic interpretation

Reference project	Nithish whole-site crop index analysis, Aug 2026
Basis of pricing	6-index satellite package, 6 blocks, 10 m resolution
Currencies	INR (domestic) and EUR / USD (export)
Document date	04 August 2026
Validity	Rates valid 90 days from document date

1 What the service delivers

A single processing job takes multispectral imagery over a defined set of field blocks and returns a complete, ready-to-use GIS package plus a written agronomic interpretation. The reference project below is the standard specification against which these rates are set.

Component	What is produced
Vegetation indices	NDVI, NDRE, EVI, NDMI, NDWI, BSI — each from its true formula, no band substitution
Radiometric QC	Conversion to surface reflectance; physical-range checks that halt the job rather than publish bad values
Cloud handling	Per-pixel cloud and shadow masking checked against the scene's own mask, not a tile average
Block clipping	Every layer clipped to block boundaries, touched-pixel inclusion so narrow strips are covered edge to edge
Classification	Two schemes per index — absolute agronomic classes and relative quintile management zones (zone 1–5)
Raster deliverables	Index values, absolute classes and zone rasters as GeoTIFF with embedded colour tables
Cartography	Rendered map sheets per index and per classification, print-ready
GIS project	QGIS project file with grouped layers, styles and relative paths — opens and works on any machine
Statistics	Per-block mean, median, standard deviation, P5 and P95 for every index; zone area tables
Report	Illustrated PDF with methodology, block ranking, findings and prioritised agronomic recommendations

1.1 Reference project specification

Parameter	Value
Site	6 field blocks, single holding
Area analysed	43.63 ha (cover) / 49.28 ha (statistical tables) — see note below
Imagery	10 m satellite multispectral, single acquisition date, 100% cloud-free over blocks
Native bands	Blue, green, red, NIR at 10 m; red-edge and SWIR at 20 m resampled to 10 m
Coordinate system	EPSG:32635 — WGS 84 / UTM zone 35N
Output volume	30 rasters, 18 style files, 18 rendered maps, 1 QGIS project, 23-page report
Turnaround	5–7 working days from imagery availability

Reconcile the billing area before invoicing

The reference report states **43.63 ha** on the cover but **49.28 ha** in every per-block statistics table — a 5.65 ha difference. Where an invoice is raised on a per-hectare basis, fix this figure first and quote the same number everywhere. A client who spots the discrepancy will question the whole invoice, not just the area line.

2 How this work should be priced

The cost of a job of this type is **approximately 90% fixed**. Boundary preparation, imagery search and QC, index computation, classification, styling, cartography, project assembly and report writing take substantially the same effort whether the site is 40 hectares or 400. The satellite imagery itself carries no licence cost. What is being sold is skilled labour and a processing pipeline, not data.

Three consequences follow, and they should shape every quotation:

- **Small sites must be priced on a minimum job fee**, not per hectare. Below roughly 200 ha a per-hectare rate does not recover the fixed effort.
- **Per-hectare rates apply only above that threshold**, and must taper as area grows — the marginal cost of additional hectares is close to zero.
- **Repeat acquisitions are where the margin sits.** Once the pipeline is configured for a site, each subsequent date costs a fraction of the first and should be sold as a season package, not as separate jobs.

2.1 Cost floor for the reference specification

Activity	Hours	Note
Boundary preparation and reprojection	1.0 – 1.5	Block digitising, CRS handling, touched-pixel clip setup
Imagery search, download, cloud QC	1.5 – 2.0	Scene selection, mask validation, reflectance conversion
Index computation and validation	2.0 – 3.0	Six indices, resampling, physical-range checks
Classification and zoning	1.5 – 2.0	Absolute classes plus quintile zones, inversion for BSI / NDWI
Styling, cartography, map export	2.5 – 4.0	18 map sheets, colour tables, legends
QGIS project assembly and packaging	1.0 – 1.5	Layer groups, relative paths, delivery structure
Statistics and report authoring	3.0 – 4.0	Per-block tables, findings, recommendations
Total skilled effort	**12.5 – 18**	**Excludes revisions and client meetings**

At an economic charge-out rate of INR 1,500–2,000 per hour, the labour floor for one delivery is ***INR 19,000–36,000****. Any quotation below INR 25,000 for this specification gives away the pipeline and the GIS project for free.*

3 Rate cards

3.1 Satellite index analysis

Covers the full specification in Section 1: six indices, both classification schemes, all rasters, map sheets, QGIS project, statistics and interpretive report.

Area band	Domestic (INR)	Export (EUR)	Effective INR / ha
Up to 50 ha	**30,000 – 45,000** flat minimum fee	**600 – 900** flat minimum fee	690 – 1,030
50 – 200 ha	400 – 550 / ha	8.00 – 11.00 / ha	400 – 550
200 – 1,000 ha	200 – 320 / ha	4.00 – 6.50 / ha	200 – 320
1,000 – 5,000 ha	100 – 160 / ha	2.00 – 3.20 / ha	100 – 160
Above 5,000 ha	45 – 85 / ha	0.90 – 1.70 / ha	45 – 85

Export rates are set independently for European and Middle-Eastern clients and are not a currency conversion of the domestic column. Quote the column that matches the client's market.

3.2 Drone imagery processing

Client supplies the raw flight imagery; processing, index generation, classification and reporting are delivered to the same standard as the satellite package.

Scope	Area band	Domestic (INR)	Export (EUR)
Orthomosaic + multispectral indices + report	Up to 50 ha	45,000 – 70,000 flat	900 – 1,400 flat
Orthomosaic + multispectral indices + report	50 – 250 ha	900 – 1,400 / ha	18 – 28 / ha
Orthomosaic + multispectral indices + report	Above 250 ha	500 – 850 / ha	10 – 17 / ha
Flight operation added (crew, mobilisation, permissions)	Any	+ 1,000 – 2,500 / ha	+ 20 – 45 / ha
RGB orthomosaic only, no index analysis	Any	250 – 450 / ha, min 20,000	5 – 9 / ha, min 400

4 Indicative quotation — reference project

Priced on the reference specification: 6 blocks, 43.63 ha, single acquisition date.

Package	Contents	Domestic (INR)	Export (EUR)
A — Satellite package	Six indices, zones, absolute classes, 30 rasters, 18 maps, QGIS project, 23-page report	**35,000 – 45,000**	**600 – 900**
B — Satellite + drone processing	Package A plus processed drone orthomosaic, high-resolution index layers and combined delivery structure	**85,000 – 1,25,000**	**1,400 – 2,200**
C — Full service	Package B plus drone flight operation and one on-site ground-truth visit	**1,10,000 – 1,75,000**	**1,800 – 3,000**

Recommended quotation: present Package A at **INR 40,000** as the headline figure, with the Section 3 rate card printed immediately beneath it and the season package from Section 5 alongside. The rate card does the selling — it shows the client that a 43 ha single-date job is the most expensive way to buy this work, and that more area or more dates is where the value lies.

5 Season packages — repeat acquisitions

A single-date map is a snapshot; a season of dates is a growth trend and a record of whether an intervention worked. Once the pipeline is configured, each repeat costs 2–3 hours against the 12–18 of the first delivery. Price the first delivery in full and repeats at 35–40%.

Package	Site size	Acquisitions	Domestic (INR)	Export (EUR)
Season monitoring	Up to 50 ha	6 – 8 across the season	**1,10,000 – 1,60,000**	2,200 – 3,400
Season monitoring	50 – 200 ha	6 – 8	1,600 – 2,400 / ha	32 – 48 / ha
Season monitoring	200 – 1,000 ha	6 – 8	700 – 1,100 / ha	14 – 22 / ha
Season monitoring	Above 1,000 ha	6 – 8	300 – 500 / ha	6 – 10 / ha
Single repeat date	Any	1 additional date	35 – 40% of the first-date fee	35 – 40% of first-date fee

Season packages should be sold as a single contract at the start of the season, invoiced monthly. They convert a one-off transaction into recurring revenue and lock out competitors for the duration.

6 Add-on line items

Add-on	What it is	Domestic (INR)	Export (EUR)
VRA prescription files	Zone rasters converted to variable-rate shapefiles that load directly into a spreader or sprayer controller	**8,000 – 15,000**	**150 – 250**
Change-detection layer	Difference maps between two dates with an area-of-change table	6,000 – 12,000	120 – 220
Additional index	Any index beyond the standard six (SAVI, GNDVI, NDRE variants, etc.)	2,500 – 4,000 each	45 – 75 each
Web map / dashboard access	Hosted viewer so the client browses layers without GIS software	15,000 – 30,000 setup + hosting	300 – 550 setup + hosting
Ground-truth field visit	On-site inspection of the flagged zone 4 and zone 5 patches, with photo log	12,000 – 25,000 per day	250 – 450 per day
Agronomist consultation	Interpretation call and written action plan against the zone maps	5,000 – 10,000 per session	100 – 200 per session
Rush delivery	Turnaround compressed to 48–72 hours	+ 30% on the job fee	+ 30% on the job fee

The prescription-file add-on is the one to push

Zone rasters are already produced; converting them to controller-ready VRA shapefiles is a short additional step on layers that exist. It is the item that moves the relationship from supplying a report to being part of the client's field operation — which is what makes the season package an easy sale next time.

7 What justifies the upper end of each band

State these explicitly in the quotation. They are the difference between this service and a low-cost NDVI screenshot, and they are what a client is actually paying for.

- **Canopy moisture (NDMI).** Derived from short-wave infrared, which no visible-band camera and no consumer drone can produce. Falling NDMI ahead of a fall in NDVI is an early irrigation-stress signal. This is the single strongest differentiator in the package.
- **Complete block coverage.** Every hectare of every block is analysed, including narrow strips — not only the ground a drone flight happened to cover.
- **Independent cross-validation.** Where satellite and drone datasets from different sensors on different days produce the same block ranking, the agreement is worth more than either dataset on its own.
- **Management zoning, not just index values.** Relative quintile zones ranked against the site's own distribution stay useful in a season where absolute values are compressed and fixed agronomic thresholds reveal nothing.
- **A GIS project that simply opens.** Grouped layers, embedded colour tables, relative paths. The client opens one file and the analysis is on screen over a basemap.
- **Verifiable quality control.** Reflectance range checks and per-pixel cloud validation that halt the job rather than publish a number that cannot be defended.

8 Commercial terms and assumptions

Item	Terms
Basis of area	Billable area is the analysed block area as stated in the delivered statistics tables, agreed in writing before work starts
Payment	50% on order, 50% on delivery. Season packages invoiced monthly across the contract
Turnaround	5–7 working days from imagery availability for the satellite package; 10–14 days where drone processing is included
Imagery risk	Where cloud cover prevents a usable acquisition within the agreed window, the date is rescheduled at no charge; the fee is not refundable on that basis
Revisions	One round of revisions to the report and cartography is included. Further rounds are billed at the hourly rate
Client inputs	Block boundaries in any GIS format, or digitised by us as a chargeable add-on. Drone processing requires complete raw imagery with flight logs
Hourly rate	INR 1,500–2,000 per hour domestic; EUR 45–75 per hour export, for scoped work outside the packages
Licence	Client receives an unrestricted licence to use the delivered layers and report internally. Processing methodology and pipeline remain our property
Taxes	All figures exclude GST and any applicable withholding tax
Validity	Rates valid for 90 days from the document date

9 Quick reference — one-page summary

Question	Answer
What do we charge for a site under 50 ha?	**INR 30,000–45,000 flat.** Never per hectare, never below INR 25,000
What is the reference project worth?	**INR 40,000** for the satellite package alone; INR 85,000–1,25,000 with drone processing
When does per-hectare pricing start to work?	Above roughly **200 ha**. Below that the fixed effort is not recovered
What is the effective per-hectare figure at 43.63 ha?	**INR 690–1,030 per hectare** — a consequence of the minimum fee, not a rate to advertise
Where is the margin?	**Season packages.** Repeats cost 2–3 hours against 12–18 for the first delivery
What is the easiest upsell?	**VRA prescription files** at INR 8,000–15,000, built from zone layers already produced
What must never be given away free?	The QGIS project, the zone rasters and the written interpretation. These are the deliverable